Guide to be Eng Frosh Remastered 2025

Introduction

This is a document for Eng frosh. It includes all the things I learned in my time here at the University of Western Ontario that I believe a first-year engineering student should know. I am in my final year of this shit while I'm writing this so I hope you can incorporate this info into your life and build on it during your university career.

London

London is a solid city. It's not horribly huge like Toronto, but it's also not super small. You can find a lot of homeless people though so if you aren't used to those (you don't live in a city or fairly large town), don't be a dick and fuck with the ones that are obviously on something. Just ignore them and don't be a degen.

Night Life

Like most college and university kids leaving home and the shackles of their parents curfews, I know you wanna know about the best bars and clubs and shit so here (not including addresses. Look it up on google you lazy bastard):

Jacks

One of the most popular spots for one reason and one reason only; *Dollar Beers*. Every Monday and Wednesday night, they host this event where, you guessed it, beers are one dollar (really its $1.25 cuz you can't have shit in London). The cups are small but it's affordable and there are two floors with a bar on each. Don't get too excited though, you're paying like a bazillion dollars to take engineering here so getting shit-faced every Monday and Wednesday night and trying to get to class the morning after (there's a 95% chance you aren't gonna make it) isn't the smartest academic play, so pick your nights wisely. Although it's pretty baller, as your senior and maybe even your soph, the last thing I want to see is some dumbass kid failing out of western eng because they got too attached to *Jacks Dollar Beers*. Be smart!

Cowboys

Also a pretty popular spot, this is a typical bar, big dance floor, open plan, they play more throw back and country music and less EDM and rap which is what most other bars play nowadays so if you're more into that kinda stuff then this place is pretty fun. However, Cowboys is pretty far from campus so plan to split ubers with people to and from if you go. 90% of the males in this bar are dressed in flannel and 50% of those, have never touched a backroad.

Ceeps

Ceeps is a solid bar. Eng Goes to Ceeps (EGTC) happens like twice a year where you go dressed in your uwo eng merch like covies, boiler suits, first year eng t-shirts and all that. They got some nice big tables and booths best utilized for card games when it's a little slower but if youre of legal age or have a goated fake, definitely try to make it out to EGTC it's better than Christmas imo (cuz it comes twice a year/ every semester) and it's a blast.

Delilahs

Fuck dels. I've been there maybe once and I just played euchre the whole time cuz it was so boring. You got a bunch of frat guys trying to spit game, and business majors trying to "network". Heard they have a nice patio though.

Joe Kools

Joe Kools is like the ol' reliable. They have live music sometimes, and everytime you go its at the very least, mid. I've never had a horrible night at Kools. There's 3 floors. The main floor has two bars, the basement has one bar, and the upstairs patio has one bar as well. There's a cool tunnel where the bathrooms are where you can get from one side of the bar to the other side by going underneath the dance floor so that's pretty sick. There's likely to be a few middle-aged people so if you're a milf/dilf hunter, this is probably where you'll have the highest success rate (but also competition). Most the older people are cool too.

Molly Blooms

This bar is basically in a basement and its actually pretty cool. They have good karaoke and theres always some absolute creatures mixed in with the uni students. On Wednesdays (Wine Wednesdays) have half off bottles of wine. I haven't been there enough to tell you to go but it's a good spot.

Winks

Best ceasars in town. Check it out.

McCabes

I love McCabes. It was frequented mostly by eng students until other faculties realized how awesome it was. Wine Wednesdays at McCabes are electric.

St. Patricks Day (St. Pattys)

Another tradition celebrated in many cities is St. Patty's. I didn't attend my first year because I was studying for a stupid physics 2 exam like a responsible studious young man, but I heard it was fun. St Patty's is like a laid-back version of foco I guess. People make these things called "borgs" (borg stands for black out rage gallon) which are gallon containers that you fill ½ to ¾ of the way with water and the rest vodka (you can mix other liquors instead of, or in tandem with the vodka I don't think it matters) and then you carry that gallon around all weekend or you could even try and take it down in a day (good luck). People write funny puns on their borg containers like last year I saw "Mark ZuckerBORG, creator of FaceBORG" or like "BORGan Freeman", "BORG to die", "BORGs a Liar Pt 2", "Soulja BORG" and the list goes on. The names are funny and it's a fun thing to do. If you're a ginger you'll get laid.

Fake-Homecoming (FOCO)

"Foco" stands for fake homecoming as homecoming is typically shortened to "hoco". After 2015 homecoming, Western decided to move the date of homecoming from the last weekend of September to the third weekend of October, which is typically when students are busy with midterms and assignments. Moving homecoming to this time in October was a measure to limit the chaos caused by homecoming and to hopefully reduce the number of Western students and non-Western students from gathering on the streets and throwing crazy parties (which have caused a lot of damage in London over the years). However, the students did not like this as homecoming is an exciting event that no one wanted to give up. So as a result, the students decided to throw their own homecoming calling it “foco”, which takes place on the original September homecoming weekend when students are not as busy with school. It is “fake homecoming” because the official Western homecoming and homecoming football game still take place but on a later date with much less attendance and chaos. Despite it being “fake” and not a Western sanctioned event, foco still draws the same large crowds and hectic parties as hoco did prior to the date change.

That entire paragraph was copy and pasted from reddit. It was explained way too well I had to.

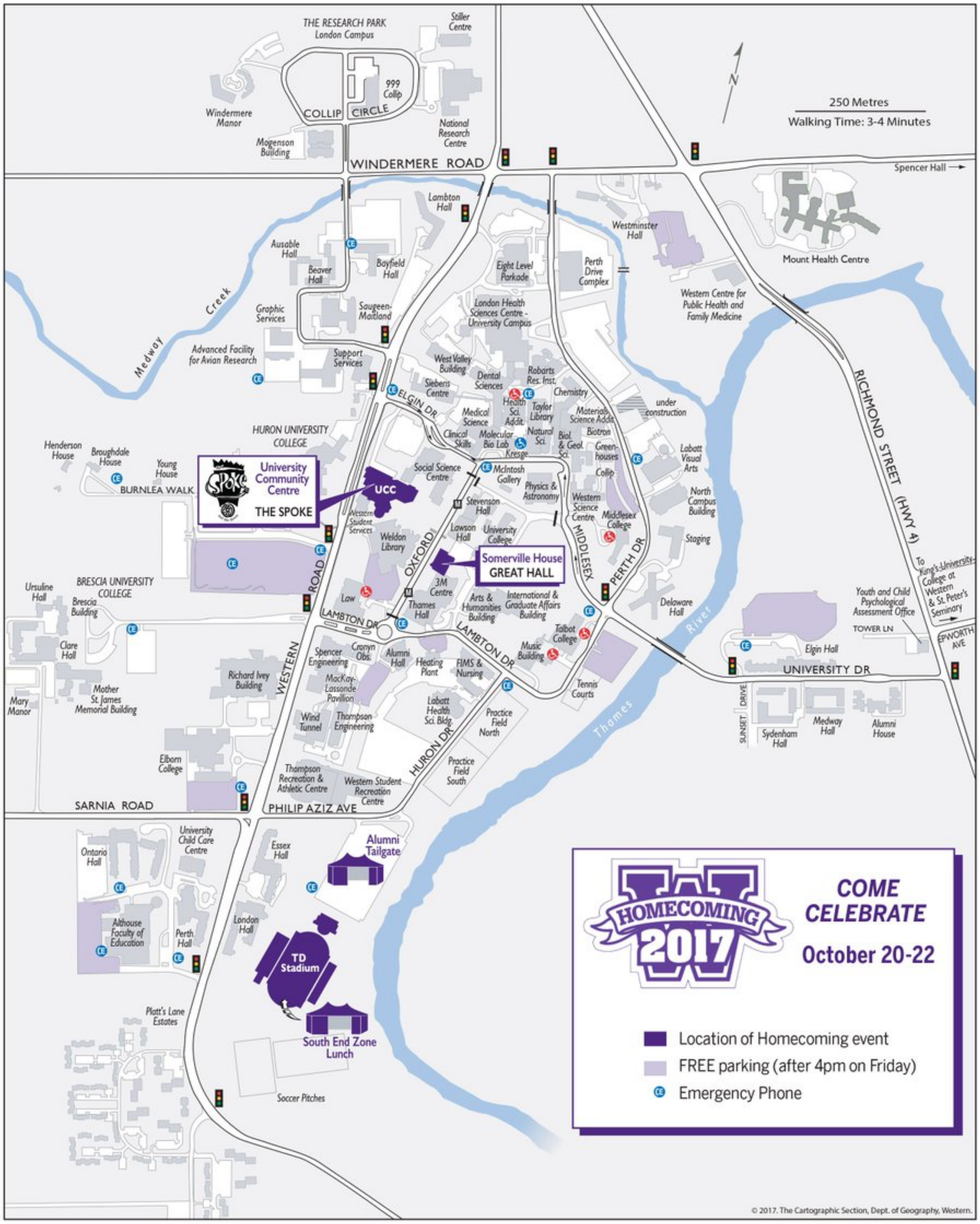
Transit

The cheapest and easiest way to get around London would be through the bus systems. A bus pass comes free with your tuition and to use the buses, just scan your Western OneCard next to the entrance of the bus. The easiest way I found to get around the city would be to look up the place you want to go on Google Maps (Google Maps is a must have application on your phone), and then click the bus option. What the app will do, is give you the times, the route the bus is taking, when it will stop at your designated location and the closest bus stop to your location so it can pick you up. It sounds complicated but that’s the best way I found. You can use Uber too if you’re not too worried about spending money and want to get somewhere specific in the least amount of time. I get that for some of you this is like second nature but all these things were new to me my first year so this advice is really for people like me coming from a town with no bus or other transit systems.

Western U

Map of Campus

Campus is kind of confusing at first but the more you walk around and go to classes and stuff, the easier it will be to get places. I’ve included a picture of the map below, but you can get an old school paper copy of one from a place in the UCC (I forget the name of it but it’s to the right of the main entrance). They’re free and you can hang one in your room for quick reference and because it looks better than just a white wall. You can also pick up a bus route map too. You can fuck around with the paper maps, or you could just look up the building name you’re trying to get to on Google Maps and follow that (another reason why it’s an essential). The latter is what I did after finding out I’m directionally challenged.



THE RESEARCH PARK
London Campus
Stiller Centre
999 Collip
COLLIP CIRCLE
Windermere Manor
Mogenson Building
National Research Centre
250 Metres
Walking Time: 3-4 Minutes
WINDERMERE ROAD
Spencer Hall
Lambton Hall
Ausable Hall
Beaver Hall
Bayfield Hall
Westminster Hall
Eight Level Parkade
Perth Drive Complex
Mount Health Centre
Western Centre for Public Health and Family Medicine
Medway Creek
Graphic Services
Saugeen-Maitland
London Health Sciences Centre - University Campus
Advanced Facility for Avian Research
Support Services
West Valley Building
Dental Sciences
Robarts Res. Inst.
Siebens Centre
Chemistry
Health Sci. Addt.
Taylor Library
Materials Science Addt.
under construction
Medical Science
Biotron
ELGIN DR
RICHMOND STREET (HWY 4)
Clinical Skills
Molecular Bio Lab
Natural Sci.
Biol. & Geol. Sci.
Greenhouses
Kresge
Labatt Visual Arts
HURON UNIVERSITY COLLEGE
Henderson House
Broughdale House
Young House
BURNLEA WALK
University Community Centre
THE SPOKE
UCC
Social Science Centre
McIntosh Gallery
Collip
Physics & Astronomy
North Campus Building
Western Student Services
Stevenson Hall
Western Science Centre
Middlesex College
Lawson Hall
University College
Staging
Weldon Library
OXFORD
MIDDLESEX
PERTH DR
Somerville House
GREAT HALL
To King's University College at Western & St. Peter's Seminary
Ursuline Hall
BRESCIA UNIVERSITY COLLEGE
Brescia Building
WESTERN ROAD
Law
3M Centre
Thames Hall
Arts & Humanities Building
International & Graduate Affairs Building
Delaware Hall
Youth and Child Psychological Assessment Office
LAMBTON DR
TOWER LN
EPWORTH AVE
Talbot College
Clare Hall
Spencer Engineering
Cronyn Obs.
Alumni Hall
Heating Plant
FIMS & Nursing
Music Building
Elgin Hall
UNIVERSITY DR
Richard Ivey Building
MacKay-Lassonde Pavilion
River
Tennis Courts
Mother St. James Memorial Building
Mary Manor
Wind Tunnel
Thompson Engineering
Labatt Health Sci. Bldg.
Practice Field North
Thames
SUNSET DRIVE
Sydenham Hall
Medway Hall
Alumni House
HURON DR
Elborn College
Practice Field South
Thompson Recreation & Athletic Centre
Western Student Recreation Centre
SARNIA ROAD
PHILIP AZIZ AVE
University Child Care Centre
Ontario Hall
Essex Hall
Alumni Tailgate
Althouse Faculty of Education
Perth Hall
London Hall
TD Stadium
Platt's Lane Estates
South End Zone Lunch
Soccer Pitches
HOMECOMING 2017
COME CELEBRATE
October 20-22
Location of Homecoming event
FREE parking (after 4pm on Friday)
Emergency Phone
© 2017. The Cartographic Section, Dept. of Geography, Western.

Your Western OneCard

This card is given to you the day you show up to your residence. In first year, especially if you live in residence, you will need this card to be able to survive. You were probably asked to submit a picture for this during the summer. This card serves a bunch of different purposes such as; what you use to be able to access the money on your meal plan, your bus pass, your ID for exams, your residence building access, your rec center access, your library card, and your study room access. You really should carry this around everywhere you go because everytime you leave your room or your house, there is a 99.99% chance you'll use it. Also, if you lose it, it costs an arm and a leg to get a new one. There's a nine-digit number on it too and that's your student number. In case you lose it, take a picture of the card so at least you have your student number (you use your student number a fair bit too so you should memorize it).

This is what a western OneCard looks like. That nine-digit number is your student number (there won't be a bar code on the right it's an old photo)

Residence

There's a bunch of different residences but there's not a lot of information I can give you since I've only visited a few. Generally though, you want to respect your floormates because you'll be living with them all year and the residence staff because they have to clean up after you. That means, clean up after yourself, don't be super loud and run around the hallways on a Wednesday night at 3am, and be nice to the people that clean the floors and work at the front desk. Some residences that are known to be rowdy, have security Thursday to Saturday from 7pm to 4am I think (I was in Saugeen, and I think that was the times). On weekends where there's big events like FOCO or St. Patrick's Day, they do security all weekend which is pretty annoying. What the security does is just scan your OneCard to make sure you belong to the residence. Its hard to have guests down during foco and St Pats.

Meal Plan

Depending on the residence, you can decide whether you want a meal plan or not, but generally, if you want one, you have to pay like $6000. In total, you get $2950 dollars to spend (the rest of the 6k goes to labour costs and stuff I think). The money is only accessible from your OneCard so you use it like you would a debit card. $2250 of that is residence dollars which can be used to buy food from any residence cafeteria. You could use your debit or credit card to buy food from res but heres the kicker, if you buy food from any res caf with your OneCard, you get 55% off so without a meal plan, eating becomes very pricey. The other $700 is flex dollars and can be used to buy food from restaurants around campus, or some vending machines (pretty high tech). If you run out of residence dollars, you start using your flex. If you run out of money completely on your meal plan, you can always add to it. To check your balance and add to your meal plan if need-be, visit Meal-Plan TopUp UWO and login using your western identity. From there you'll be able to figure out the rest. The $2950 you get is for ALL YEAR not just one semester so don't eat 8 meals a day, simple.

Important Dates

I found this list online of important dates for the 2025-2026 UWO school year so I took a screenshot and put it here so its easily accessible to you. I would mark these dates in your calendar or send the picture to your parents so they know when you're off school and you can plan to go home and rot.

Sept 1, 2025	Labour Day; Western closed
Sept 4, 2025	Fall/ Winter term classes begin
Sept 12, 2025	Last day to add a full course, a first-term half course, a first-term full course, or a full-year half course on campus and Distance Studies
Sept 30, 2024	National Day for Truth and Reconciliation (observed as a non-instructional day at Western)
Oct 13, 2025	Thanksgiving Holiday, Western closed
Nov 3-9, 2025	Fall Reading Week
Dec 9, 2025	Fall/ Winter Term classes end
Dec 10, 2025	Study Day
Dec 11-22	Mid-year examination period
Jan 5, 2026	Classes resume
Jan 13, 2025	Last day to add or drop a second-term half course
Feb 14-22, 2026	Spring Reading Week
Feb 16 2026	Family Day; Western closed
Mar 30, 2026	Last day to drop a second-term half course without academic penalty
April 3, 2026	Good Friday; Western closed
April 9, 2026	Fall/Winter Term classes end
April 10-11, 2026	Study Days
April 12-30, 2026	Final examination period

Academics:

It's hard

Like most engineering students and most first year university students, you may have found it easy to get good grades in high school. In university though, it's hard to get really good grades, and the biggest realization I found was that I was no longer at the top of my class, and it rattled me. You may fail an exam, fail a quiz, maybe even a class but it is not the end of the world. If any of those happen, you just have to learn from it, make a new strategy, and do better on the next one.

Western Engineering (aka uwo eng)

Western engineering is a 4-year program. The first year is always general and every first-year engineering student takes the exact same courses no matter what discipline they want to pursue. These courses are Linear Algebra, Calculus 1, Calculus 2, Physics 1, Physics 2, Statics, Business, Materials, Programming and Design.

UWO Owl

This website is probably the most important because everything about your classes, your grades, schedules, some tests and quizzes, assignments and announcements are shared through here. You log into it using your western ID (this should be given to you real early) and the rest is up to you to figure out because it's way too hard to explain. If you need any help with logging in or navigating the website, ask your eng soph and I'm sure they would be happy to help you out.

The Stick

One thing you must understand is that it is stupid hard to get through Western Engineering without cheating. You WILL cheat on an assignment, you WILL copy someone else's work, and you WILL violate academic integrity. This is completely normal so don't feel bad. All these profs are being paid stupid amounts of money to teach the absolute bare minimum and expect 17 to 19-year-old kids to be able to complete 3-hour exams on stuff that was brought up briefly to 5 kids who showed up to the 8:30am class after St Patrick's day. For that reason, The Stick was created. There's a whole document of what it is and stuff but heres a summary; the stick has been passed on for generations to first years and is constantly improved by every soph team. It is a file that has made the first year of every engineering student somewhat bearable. It holds a bunch of old tests, assignments, exams, and so much more. The Stick is very important and should never be mentioned to ANYBODY other than western engineering students. This means you should never utter a word about the stick OR ITS CONTENTS to your profs, your parents, your siblings, your dog, your gf/bf and UNDER NO CIRCUMSTANCES WESTERN ADMINISTRATION. If anyone finds out, your life and the lives of every other first year student to come will be a living hell.

Course Breakdown

The first thing you do at the start of the year or even better, a week or two before, is to download every course syllabus. To do this, go onto owl, go to the class you want, and there should be a bunch of tabs on the side, one should say "syllabus" or "course overview" click that thing and read it then download it as a pdf or something to your computer. There should be an evaluation breakdown, and this will show how much each evaluation is weighted (ex. Assignments: 15%

Quizzes: 10% Labs: 10% Midterm: 25% Final: 40%). This will become very important at the end of each term so you can calculate your grade so far and see what you need on the final in order to pass the course (you will do this for at least one class guaranteed). All other information on the syllabus will include midterm/final exam dates, what days labs are on, and pretty much a bunch of other general information about that class and what the prof expects you to do throughout the term. A general rule of thumb that I found best is to absolutely dial the fuck in for every midterm and knock that shit out of the park with a somewhat high grade (midterms are easier to get a good mark on than finals) and so you can kind of move aside the easier courses finals like mats and lin alg and focus on the hard finals like calc or physics.

How to Pass

Although I don't recommend doing the absolute bare minimum because that's how you can easily get fucked but this is what you need to pass first year engineering; You'll need at least an OVERALL percentage of 60% between all your classes, and you'll need at least a 50% in every class. This basically means you need to pass every class, and still maintain an average of 60% or higher. Depending on the discipline you want to go into though, some require a higher percentage either overall, or in specific classes. Below is a breakdown of each.

Program	**Year 1 Average (YWA)**	**First consideration given to applicants with a minimum grade of 60% in each of the following courses:**
Chemical	> 60%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Chem 1302A/B, ES 1050
Civil	> 60%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Phys 1401A, ES 1022Y, ES 1021A/B
Electrical	> 60%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Phys 1402B, ES 1036A/B
Integrated	> 60%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Bus 1299E, Phys 1401A, Phys 1402B, ES 1022y
Mechanical	> 60%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Phys 1401A, ES 1022Y, ES 1021A/B
Mechatronics	> 70%	NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Phys 1401A, Phys 1402B, ES 1022Y, ES 1036A/B, ES 1050
Software	> 60%	Applicants are required to have a minimum of 60% in NMM 1411A/B, NMM 1412A/B, NMM 1414A/B, Physics 1402A/B and a minimum of 70% in ES 1036A/B and a Year 1 Average (YWA) 60%.
Biomedical	> 60%	To be eligible for the BME option in your desired program, all of the requirements of the first-year curriculum in the Faculty of Engineering must be completed with a minimum year-weighted average (YWA) of 70%.
Artificial Intelligence Systems	> 75%	To be eligible for the AISE option in your desired program, all of the requirements of the first-year curriculum in the Faculty of Engineering must be completed with a minimum year-weighted average (YWA) of 75%.

Academic Advisors

Whether you like it or not, you'll likely have to deal with an academic advisor at least once in your university career. The most common comparison to an academic advisor is your high school guidance counsellor. If you have any questions to do with school that your eng soph can't answer, your academic advisor likely can. I've had great experiences with academic advisors (Nicole Harding the goat) but there's always a chance you'll get fucked over on accident (just like a guidance counsellor) so if it sounds too good to be true or you don't trust the plan, ask them questions about it and make sure you understand everything that is going on. For example, if you took ap physics, you could drop physics 1 because you already learned it. If you can save yourself time to study other classes, you think you'll remember how to do physics in January, and you took aphysics in high school, you should consider dropping that physics class you know? If you have questions about the following, your academic advisor is who you should contact sooner rather than later; admission to second year programs (ITR), academic planning, adding or dropping courses, academic consideration (you have to miss a quiz, test, exam, assignment for an outstanding circumstance), appeals, information and more.

The Academic Advisors for you cute little baby frosh this year are:

Karen Murray
Email: kmurra3@uwo.ca
Last names A-Q

Alexandra Bannon
Email: abannon4@uwo.ca
Last names R-Z

If you need to book an appointment to talk to them irl, email your respective academic advisor depending on the first letter of your last name and they'll either schedule it for you, or point you in the right direction to schedule it yourself. If you don't even want to fuck around with an email go visit their office at the Spencer Engineering Building Room 2097.

First Year Classes

All the strategies and ways I got through these classes are based on personal preference. You may have better strategies or have different ways of learning so use the information I give you as a reference. What I'm trying to say is that the way I passed these classes isn't the only way to do so.

Linear Algebra (aka Lin Alg)

Pretty shit class. It's boring, you'll probably never apply anything taught into any discipline, the classes are usually at 8:30am every Monday, Wednesday, and Friday and the profs are hot garbage (most profs are but the ones who teach this are always ass). It's also a one semester course. This class, and materials is by far the most skipped but keep up to date maybe take some notes off YouTube every other week and at least try to understand things for when you have a test or quiz. Keeping up to date will also make it so you don't have to spend so long catching up when studying for the midterm or final. A good YouTube channel for this class would be Nick Dale. He's the guy I depended on to get through Lin Alg. He explains things well and does examples.

Materials (aka Mats)

Light course in the past and is only a semester. In 2021-2022 and 2022-2023, mats was set up to where the end of term project, the quizzes, the midterm, the final, and the tutorial assignments were all worth 20% so it was really easy to get a good grade. The teachers are usually bad and you don't really learn much about materials but it's easy to get through. A popular saying among my eng friends was "mats doesn't exist" which was true all term except for 2 days before the midterm (I didn't even study for the final and still pulled off a 69% in the class. It really is that easy to get a good grade).

Calculus 1 (aka Calc 1)

Kind of a hard class but it's only a semester. Most of it is review of high school calculus until after the midterm and then it gets hard. Calc 1 and 2 used to just be calc which was a full year course but because so many people were failing and having to take a whole year long course again, they decided to split it up into two half year classes so in case you did fail one of them, you only had to take an extra course during one semester. This is definitely a class I would use my strategy of killing the midterm which consists of concepts you already know so you don't have to screw around with hard new concepts and try and get your grade up to pass. If you're confused about any concepts new or old there's tons of YouTube channels for calc. TheOrganicChemistryTutor will always be the GOAT but blackpenredpen and ProfessorDaveExplains are also pretty good channels.

Calculus 2 (aka Calc 2)

An even harder class than calc 1 because it's pretty much all new shit so get pumped. Still only a one semester class though. The midterms and finals for calc 1 and calc 2 are all pretty hard and a lot of people don't do good on them. There were usually bi-weekly assignments online you had to do and it's easy to cheat by using the internet. The same bi-weekly assignments were in calc 1. Not sure if you guys will do these this year though because they probably realized people were cheating when the average for these assignments was a 95% and yet everyone was failing their midterms and finals. If you do have these bi-weekly assignments and you want to know how to cheat (for curiosity only of course) ask your soph "how do you cheat on online calc assignments"? The same YouTube channels I mentioned in calc 1 I used during this.

Physics 1

Similar to calc 1 where it's pretty much high school review but last year it was review up to maybe ¾ of the semester. There's like one brand new unit, I think. If your prof is Silvia Mittler though good luck because she is shit. I did grade 11 and 12 physics in grade 11 when it was covid and got really good grades without learning anything so I kind of fucked myself. The midterms and finals are really hard for this course too. The best YouTube channel for this class is TheOrganicChemistryTutor too (god among men really).

Physics 2

Again, very similar to calc 2 where its way harder than physics 1. Was also split up into two half-year courses because it was so hard to pass. For physics 1 and 2 last year there was this thing called Perusall readings every week where you had to "read" a section of the textbook online and annotate stuff. This was easy to cheat because the program written to check your work was pretty bad (because there's no way the prof would read everyone's annotations) and all you had to get a perfect score was highlight like a phrase or topic and then open up your trusty ChatGPT and put "write 5 sentences about (insert thing you highlighted)" and boom that's one down 4 to go. You had to do that like 5 times, and it takes you 5 minutes. You don't even have to touch it for the rest of the week. The concepts and exams were hard, but everyone always gets through it. TheOrganicChemistryTutor is still best.

Programming (aka Java Brogramming, aka Prog)

For the people who took some form of programming (or better yet java programming) in high school, this class was by far the easiest. A girl I know ripped a 99% in this class easily. In this class you learn how to use the coding language Java. I was not one of those people who took it in high school, so it was really hard. Best strategy here is to find and befriend someone who took it in high school so they can teach you stuff and in a pinch you can cheat off them. I have searched the internet tirelessly for a good way to learn this stuff, but programming is such a broad topic, and there are so many different programming languages and ways of teaching it that I wasn't able to find anything I understood.

Chemistry (aka Chem)

By far the most organized class out of all first-year classes. You buy a textbook and a lab manual. The textbook is organized by unit, it's a physical book (only one other than business that doesn't have a digital textbook), and it has homework questions (I highly recommend you do these or at least try to) after every unit and sub-unit. The lab manual is also a physical book and consists of the instructions for every lab, the work sheets for them, and at the very back of the book, they give you the midterms and finals for the past few years and the solutions for them so you can practice. If you do this course exactly how they design it to be taken, you will pass with above a 70% easily. Science students take this course with you I think so there's rarely a curve at all for any exams. It's a half year course and if after reading the textbook, and attending the lessons, you still don't understand something, refer to TheOrganicChemistryTutor's YouTube channel again (I swear I love this man).

Statics

Statics is kind of a fun class. I may be biased though because I'm a civil engineering student now (reason I picked civil is because I enjoyed it so much) but still a lot of people I know in other disciplines said this class was their favourite. Lectures were on Tuesdays and Thursdays, and if you keep up with the material, you will easily pass. This is a 0.5 credit course but its yearlong so don't screw it up (a lot of first years fail and have to retake it because it's easy to get behind on material). The strategy I used to succeed in this course was to show up to all the lectures to get the participation marks (last year there were participation marks which you earned by completing a question online that he posted during the lecture and you never knew when he would post one so you had to attend the lectures to know when he did them), and to make a note of what unit we were on (then I'd fuck around with my friends for the rest of it). After the lectures, I would go back to my dorm and watch a few YouTube videos on the unit we were learning about on Jeff Hanson's channel (he literally has every unit we learn throughout the year under the *Statics* playlist) and took notes using that because he teaches statics really well (better than my prof at the time at least). Before tests and quizzes and stuff though, I would go to another YouTube channel called Question Solutions and their statics videos basically give you an easy, a medium, and a hard difficulty example for every statics unit and shows you how to solve them. I would watch Jeff Hanson videos to learn, and then try the Question Solutions questions before the solutions part and use the solutions to check my work and see what steps I got wrong. When studying for the midterm and final though, I would also do a few textbook questions because the textbook for statics last year was honestly pretty good. I don't want you guys to get lazy and put statics on the back burner because it will bend you over if you aren't careful.

Business (aka Bizz)

This course is your full-year writing course. Western has this fancy business school called Ivey so they make this mandatory for engineering students in case they want to pursue a dual degree in any discipline of engineering and business. If you're into business, you'll like this class. With business classes it's difficult to give advice since whether you succeed easily or not depends on the professor and your ability to bullshit. Unless you're really trying to get a good mark to get into Ivey, the difficulty to pass is moderate. The textbook and all the units you learn are almost identical to the business 1229 class BMOS students usually take so if your roommate is in business or you have a friend in it, I would call that an asset in case you need help with a concept (they want a degree in business so they should be good at it). The textbook is THICK too so when you go home, you can show it off and look cool. Classes are 3 times a week, the more you talk and ask questions in class, the more contribution marks you get (contribution marks carry), there were 5 evaluations; 3 "big tests" after 3 of the 4 units, a group project after the other one and then the final was a combination of all the tests. The release videos on how to do the stuff you're meant to know on OWL under "Course Content" and its super hard to fail this class but also super hard to get more than a 90%.

Design (aka 1050)

A kind of boring class but also really easy. Its year-long, there is usually one lecture a week (you'll probably attend it 3 times at the beginning of the year and not once after) and one lab a week. Labs are mandatory whereas the lecture is not. There is a lot of homework and assignments for this class that are easy, but time consuming, so try not to leave them to last minute. During the labs, you sit at a table with a group of people you are put with at the start of each semester, and you are basically told to talk about, or do stuff regarding a project with an objective you're given at the beginning of the year. You'll probably procrastinate everything in this class but try not to be lazy and help your group and pull your weight as much as you can because you'll probably see them again down the road in another design class, a co-op, or a job.

Prep 101

Probably the only reason I passed calculus or physics. Prep 101 is a website where you can take courses that give you access to really good review and practice material for exams. Prep 101 holds like zoom meetings that you join where an instructor reviews a bunch of stuff from a specific course and does practice problems from old midterms or exams. The meetings are all recorded too so that's what most people use so they can go over the material at their own pace. They have a course for just about every class (all except business and design I think) and last year the midterm content for every one was free too (you'll have to pay for the finals stuff). I really do recommend implementing this into your study plan for exams because it really did help me and a lot of other first years. There is a lot of content though and it takes a long time to get through so plan accordingly.

Curves

The all-time best thing to ever exist in the world is what every university student calls "The Curve". This beautiful thing quite literally saves lives. The concept is, after a midterm or final for any class, if the average between all the people who took it is below a certain percent (depends on the class) they will add a certain number of marks or a certain percentage to everyone's grade to make the class average meet the required amount by Western. Some finals in the past few years have had class averages so low, they have had to get curved like 40% because the exam was that hard. It's put in place so that people still pass if the profs made the exam really hard for no reason which happens a lot. If you ever feel super shit about a calc or physics midterm or final, there's still hope for you because its highly likely they'll curve it.

Other Programs at Western

You may think you're better than everyone else because you're in engineering, but I highly suggest you get rid of that opinion quick. Everyone pays a boatload of money to come here, and everyone is following a career they believe best fits them. Just as you are, so don't be a dick and respect all other faculties no matter how easy it sounds. I don't want to accidentally be bias towards any faculty so I'm just going to list the programs and what most people refer to them as. If you want to find out more information about them, I recommend talking to people in that program.

Engineering: Referred to as Eng (pronunciation I think is self-explanatory but it's *enj*).

Eng Disciplines: You will be meeting upper year engineering students so here is a list of different short forms we use when referring to our disciplines:

Mechanical: Mech
Mechatronics: Tron
Civil: Civil (we aren't special enough to have a short form)

Biomedical: Bio-Med
Chemical: Chem
Integrated: Integrated (I know one guy. His name is matthew.)
Double major with Business: They'll say their major and then "with Ivey" or "and business".
Double major with AI: They'll say their major and then just say "AI" after.

You can get a minor in another subject with engineering like I've seen my upper years say "with a minor in physics" or it'll be psychology or whatever but I'm not too familiar with it and I don't know much about it so I'm not gonna pretend like I do. You don't gotta worry about that stuff yet anyway. Mech and tron confused me the most because they both started with "mech" so when someone said, "I'm in mech" I would always ask, "mechanical or mechatronics?" like a complete and utter neanderthal. Now to the other programs.

Medical Sciences: Med Sci

Social Sciences: Social Sci

General Sciences: Gen Sci

Health Sciences: Health Sci

Psychology: Psych

Arts and Humanities: Art

Kinesiology: Kin

Nursing: Nursing

Media, Information and Technoculture: MIT (pronounced *em eye tee*)

Music: Music

Bachelor of Management and Organizational Studies: BMOS (pronounced *bee moss*)

Most of those were self-explanatory but MIT confused me (because of the MIT in the states) and so did BMOS (I thought it was just business but its not. Talk to a business student if you want to learn more).

AEO

The term AEO is a term mostly mentioned by students who want to go to Ivey. AEO directly stands for Advanced Entry Opportunity. A person is granted AEO when they apply to Ivey in high school, and if their high school grades were high enough, Ivey basically says "alright you're pretty good at this school stuff, keep an average above 80% (for engineering its 78%) throughout your first two years at Western, and you are guaranteed a spot at the Ivey Business School". When I refer to someone who has AEO, I just say "they're Ivey bound". If you have AEO in first year, don't go around saying you're doing a dual-degree with business. Just say you WANT to instead. You're not in Ivey yet lil bro so pipe down.

ERTW

The term literally stands for "engineers rule the world". You may see it in eng buildings, or around campus throughout the year. The term may seem cocky, but it really isn't. It is simply true. Engineers do what they do to better the world and humankind as a whole. That is the essence of "ERTW". We are engineers. We work harder, think harder, and party harder. We don't say it, we show it. Easy as that.

Sports

Sports and other physical activities are a massive part of staying mentally sane while you're in university. You cannot lock yourself in your dorm room all day, every day and study. You will drive yourself crazy, you won't make friends, and your body will deteriorate. There will be times when you will have to do that for a few days or maybe even a week but that's besides the point. You need to take breaks occasionally and physical activity is awesome for that. The health benefits are numerous and its better for your body and bank account than going out to the bars every Friday and Saturday. Here is what you gotta know.

The Rec Center

This is the shortform for recreation center. This is an absolute unit of a building. It has 2 gyms, both with 3 basketball courts, a free-weight gym, a bunch of treadmills, an Olympic sized swimming pool, a hockey rink, a track, squash courts, ping pong tables, and probably a lot more that I'm forgetting. The hours differ depending on the date so click here if you want more info on times.

For people who like playing sports:

Intramurals

These are organized sports through Western University. You pay money to be able to register a team or join a team for every respective sport. Here's the list of all the sports copy and pasted right from the website:

Badminton

Badminton is one of the more popular sports on campus. Between drop in and our badminton club there are hundreds of students taking part in this fun game. So come join us for one of the fastest growing sports on campus! Leagues are offered in the fall and winter.

Ball Hockey

Intramural Sports offers ball hockey leagues in both the fall and winter semesters. Fall is offered outdoors in the 'O-Rink' and indoors in the Rec Center and the winter leagues are offered indoors in the Rec Centre.

Basketball
Intramural Sports offers basketball players a wide selection of leagues to choose from. Basketball leagues are offered in the fall, winter and summer semesters.

3 on 3 Basketball
3 on 3 Basketball is played on half court and is a fun way to clean off the rust and stay active. Intramural Sports offers 3 on 3 Basketball leagues in both the fall and winter semesters.

Unified Basketball
Intramural Sports offers basketball players a wide selection of leagues to choose from. This specific league promotes inclusion on campus by providing the opportunity for individuals with and without intellectual disability to play on the same team.

Beach Volleyball
Intramural Beach Volleyball is a great summer and fall sport and regardless of your skill or experience intramural sports has a league for you.

Dodgeball
Dodge Ball is an incredibly popular and fun way to bond as a team, meet new people, and get in some deserved stress relief! Dodge ball leagues are offered in the fall and winter semesters.

European Handball
This co-ed sport of 6 on 6 introduces the skill and fun of soccer, mixed with basketball, mixed with... well, you'll just need to try it out! Intramural Sports offers European handball leagues in both the fall and winter semesters.

Flag Football (Snow Flag Snow for Winter Semester))
Intramural Sports offers three seasons of flag football during the fall, winter, and summer semesters. Flag allows for a faster more dynamic air attack game.

Futsal
Futsal is a skilful variation of indoor soccer but played within the lines as opposed to against the walls. Futsal leagues are offered in the fall and winter semesters.

Ice Hockey
Intramural Sports offers ice hockey leagues in the fall that continue through the winter term, with a full season consisting of AT LEAST 10 regular season games plus playoffs.

Inner-tube Water Polo
Inner-tube Water Polo is played in the wonderful Western Student Recreation Centre 50 metre pool. One of the most popular, fun, and surprisingly challenging sports leagues. Intramural Sports offers inner-tube water polo leagues in both the fall and winter semesters.

Pickleball
A fun sport that combines many elements of tennis, badminton, and table tennis. Played on a badminton-sized court and a slightly modified tennis net. Leagues are offered in the fall and

winter.

Slo-Pitch
Intramural Slo-Pitch is a summer and fall semester tradition at Western. People of all skill levels fall in love with this game and the dynamic mixture of experience and enthusiasm creates an exhilarating atmosphere on the field. For a purely relaxing and recreational experience please check out our 3-pitch option.

3-Pitch
Intramural 3-pitch is a summer and fall semester tradition at Western. People of all skill levels fall in love with this game and the dynamic mixture of experience and enthusiasm creates an exhilarating atmosphere on the field. For a more competitive game please check out our slo-pitch options.

Soccer
Many divisions and opportunities for one of Western Intramural Sports most popular fall and summer leagues.

7 on 7 Soccer (Snow 7 on 7 Soccer for Winter Semester)
Be a part of Western's 7-on-7 Soccer league! Smaller field and goals, fast paced and high scoring! Intramural Sports offers 7 on 7 soccer leagues in the fall, winter and summer semesters.

Spikeball
Spikeball is played 2 vs 2. Described as kinda sorta like volleyball and foursquare but on steroids. Intramural Sports offers spikeball leagues in the fall, winter and summer semesters.

Ultimate Frisbee
Intramural Sports offers ultimate frisbee leagues in both the summer and fall semesters. Ultimate is a great team game involving disc skills and fitness and sportsmanship play is always encouraged as there are no officials. Co-ed ultimate is played with 7 players on the field 3 of which must be female. Whether you are new to the sport or an experienced player the IMS ultimate league is sure to catch your fancy.

Volleyball
Intramural Sports offers volleyball players a wide selection of leagues to choose from. Leagues are offered in the fall and winter semesters. Volleyball is a great team sport and regardless of your skill or experience intramural sports has a league for you.

<u>Summary of how it works:</u>

Its organized so that you can make a team as a team captain and just add people to your team, you can join someone else's team, or you can join as a free agent which means they just throw you on a team with a bunch of other free agents. Spots on the free agent team is limited though. If you don't make it in time, some teams are looking for extra players and so you can post your profile and add a description of your sports history or something on the website (it's called IMleagues and it sucks ass) and other team captains can like scout you to join their team. To be able to play, you must take an online test based on the rules of the sport you chose. There's also a bunch of different sports rules that the university put in place specific to each sport like for example, in the ice hockey leagues, you can't body-check, or in the soccer leagues, you can't slide tackle. Basically, rules to keep the university from being sued and to protect them from idiots who can't play the game properly. There is a competitive league (comp) and a recreational league (rec) for every sport. Also, there is co-ed, male, and female leagues.

How to sign-up for sports

To sign up, go their website shop.westernmustangs.ca, sign in, click on "program registration", search for the sport you'd like to play, and add it to your cart. There are prices next to the sports and that's how much it costs to play them. You can add, play, and pay for multiple sports but you can only join one team per league like for example, if you wanted to play soccer, you could play on a competitive team, a recreational team, and the gender specific and coed for both. That's a lot of soccer tho ngl. When you're done picking, you can pay for everything that you put in your cart like shopping. Then they'll send you some emails about how to log into IMleagues (such a bad website) and I'm sure you can figure the rest out yourself.

LUG

Most first years don't do LUG but I know first years who have. LUG is a company I guess that organizes sports leagues for college/university students. I don't know much about it, how to register, or any of that but I know it's a little pricey, its off campus, its more competitive, the jerseys look pretty cool, and games and stuff are a few times a week. For more information visit their website.

Drop-ins

Every weekday (and maybe on weekends idrk) the rec center does these things called drop-ins. They basically post on their app, *Western Rec* and under a tab called "drop-ins" they'll post times where you can go in and play pickup games of a bunch of different sports. The most popular are basketball, volleyball, and badminton but I think there are other ones. This is a good way to burn an afternoon or just screw around if you're really bored or burnt out from studying.

For people who hit gym

I had been to the western free-weight gym once and it gets packed, especially in the afternoon. The times it's the least busy would be real early in the mornings at like 6am (maybe earlier but idk bc I've never been crazy enough to wake up that early) or later at night between 9 and 11pm. There's a website or something where you can check how many people are occupying the gym at any given time, but I don't know what it's called, nor have I used it.

Other

If you aren't interested in lifting heavy plates or joining a sports team, the pool is open usually every morning (it's called "fit lane swim" in the link I gave you in the paragraph under "Rec Center"). A few of my friends from my res floor did that and they said it was fun. There's a track in the rec center (around the rink) and an outdoor one at the stadium (the track teams are probably using it most the time, but you may be able to squeak in once in a while) if you want to walk or run around there. There are plenty of walking trails and stuff around campus if you don't just want to run around in circles. Its fun to just explore the paths and see where you end up but you can also just look uo "walking paths around uwo" in google.

Conclusion

Your sophs are there to help you in any way whether it be during o-week or even after. The engineering sophs even do review things before midterms and finals for every class and those are super helpful. If you have any questions about anything don't be afraid to ask a soph, whether it be your own, another eng soph, or another soph in general. If you made it this far, thank you for taking the time to read this and I hope the information I made available to you helps some way in the future. Best of luck to you all.

Sincerely,

Soup